Lemmas VI and VII told us that as B slides toward A the arc AB and its chord merge with the tangent AD, and the angle between them vanishes. But that only says the gap closes — it does not say *how fast*. The deep question of curvature is: as the small distance AB shrinks, by what power does the curve peel away from its flat tangent? Everything about force and orbit in the later Propositions rests on the answer, so we measure the departure of the curve from the line it kisses at A.